# Israel Ariraya Radiaganding

**Dr. Israel Ariraya Radiaganding** (born December 26, 1990) is a Maranao Muslim Filipino engineer, educator, public servant, and cultural leader from Angeles City, Pampanga.

He's widely recognized as one of the first Muslim Filipinos to graduate in Railway Engineering and Management in the Philippines, a distinction that places him at the forefront of both the country's growing transportation sector and its broader narrative of Bangsamoro representation in fields historically dominated by others.

Today, he serves as Chief Transportation Development Officer at the Philippine Railways Institute under the Department of Transportation, where he leads the development of the country's railway workforce.

Alongside his government role, he teaches at the Polytechnic University of the Philippines Manila and carries the cultural title of Sultan a Rumapunut in Pampanga, making him one of the rare figures who holds meaningful standing in engineering, academia, governance, and community leadership all at once.

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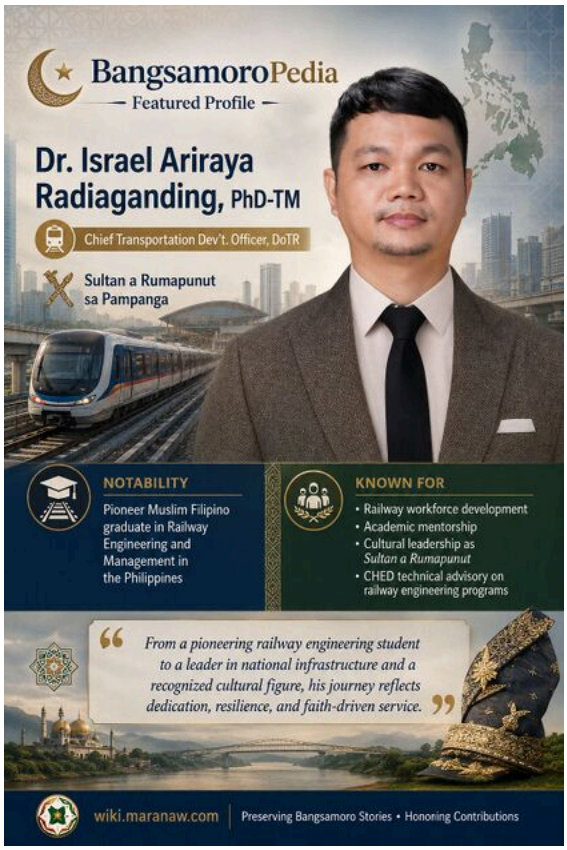

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## Background

Israel Ariraya Radiaganding was born on December 26, 1990, in Angeles City, Pampanga, to Hadji Nasser Radiaganding and Hadja Nasrifah Mauyag Ariraya Radiaganding.

His Maranao roots ground his identity as a proud Muslim Filipino, even as he was raised in Pampanga, far from the traditional heartland of the Maranao in Lanao del Sur.

Dr. Israel Ariraya Radiaganding




**Personal Information**

**Born:** December 26, 1990

Angeles City, Pampanga, Philippines

**Ethnicity**

Maranao

**Religion**

Islam

**Parents**

Hadji Nasser Radiaganding (father)

Hadja Nasrifah Mauyag Ariraya Radiaganding (mother)

**Education**

B.S. Railway Engineering and Management, Polytechnic University of the Philippines

His parents instilled in him the values that would define his path: perseverance, discipline, and faith. Those aren't just words in his biography. They're the through-line of a life built on hard work and a genuine sense of purpose.

His journey from humble beginnings in Central Luzon to national leadership in Manila is, in many ways, a quiet but powerful story of what's possible for Muslim Filipinos who push past the boundaries set by geography and circumstance.

# Education

Dr. Radiaganding completed his early schooling in Angeles City before pursuing higher education in Manila.

He earned his **Bachelor of Science in Railway Engineering and Management** from the Polytechnic University of the Philippines (PUP), graduating as a Shell Scholar, a distinction that recognized both his academic merit and his potential.

That degree placed him among the first Muslim Filipinos to specialize in railway engineering, a field that was still establishing its academic footing in the Philippines during his student years.

He went on to earn a **Master of Science in Management Engineering** from Pamantasan ng Lungsod ng Maynila, deepening his grounding in both technical and organizational systems.

He completed his academic formation with a **Doctor of Philosophy in Technology Management** from the Technological University of the Philippines, equipping him with the research and policy perspective needed for national-level leadership.

M.S. Management Engineering, Pamantasan ng Lungsod ng Maynila Ph.D. Technology Management, Technological University of the Philippines

**Current Position**

Chief Transportation Development Officer, Philippine Railways Institute, Department of Transportation

**Other Role**

Part-time Faculty, Polytechnic University of the Philippines Manila

**Cultural Title**

Sultan a Rumapunut, Pampanga

**Career Start**

2012 (railway sector)

**Notability**

Pioneer Muslim Filipino graduate in Railway Engineering and Management in the Philippines

**Known For**

Railway workforce development; academic mentorship; cultural leadership as Sultan a Rumapunut; CHED technical advisory on railway engineering programs

**Pull Quote**

*"From a pioneering railway engineering student to a leader in national infrastructure and a recognized cultural figure, his journey reflects dedication, resilience, and faith-driven service."*

# Professional Career

Dr. Radiaganding stepped into the railway sector in 2012, building his expertise in planning, project development, and corporate strategy during the country's early push to modernize its rail infrastructure.

He served at the Department of Transportation and Communications (now the Department of Transportation) and at the Light Rail Transit Authority (LRTA), where he gained hands-on exposure to the operational and planning realities of urban rail systems.

He later rejoined the Department of Transportation, this time at the Philippine Railways Institute (PRI), where his career advanced steadily from Supervising Transportation Development Officer to his current role as **Chief Transportation Development Officer**.

In that capacity, he now leads the institute's human resource development agenda, shaping how the country trains and certifies its railway professionals.

His academic career runs parallel to his government service. He started teaching as early as 2015, serving as a faculty member and research adviser, and continues to teach part-time at PUP Manila, mentoring students in engineering, research methods, and railway systems.

## Leadership in Railway, Education, and Culture

As Training Head of the Philippine Railways Institute, Dr. Radiaganding is directly responsible for building the technical capacity of the country's railway workforce.

His work in that role includes designing competency-based training programs for railway professionals, aligning academic curricula with both industry needs and international standards, mentoring learners in railway transportation, and supporting broader capacity-building initiatives across the sector.

Beyond the technical side, he brings the same seriousness to his role as a resource person for the Commission on Higher Education (CHED), where he contributes to the evaluation of railway engineering programs and helps ensure that what students learn in Philippine universities is relevant, current, and globally competitive.

His role as **Sultan a Rumapunut in Pampanga** adds another dimension to his leadership. It's a cultural and community responsibility, not just a title, and it speaks to his commitment to representing Muslim heritage and identity in a region where the Muslim community is a minority.

## Institutional and National Impact

Through his work at the Philippine Railways Institute, Dr. Radiaganding is helping to build something the country genuinely needs: a skilled, professional, and sustainable railway workforce.

The Philippines is investing heavily in rail infrastructure, and the human capital behind that infrastructure matters just as much as the tracks and trains. His work sits squarely at that intersection.

His involvement with CHED as a Technical Resource Person also ensures that railway engineering education keeps pace with national and international standards, a contribution that shapes not just current professionals but the next generation of railway engineers.

## Recognition

Dr. Radiaganding has been recognized as one of the **Faces of Inspiration** of Angeles City National High School, an acknowledgment of his journey from student to national leader and of the example he sets for young Filipinos, especially those from the Muslim community.

His standing as Sultan a Rumapunut further affirms his role as a recognized figure not just in professional circles but within his cultural community.

# Legacy

Dr. Israel Ariraya Radiaganding represents a new generation of Muslim Filipino leaders who are making their mark far beyond the traditional boundaries drawn for them.

He's a pioneer in a technical field that barely had Muslim Filipino representation when he started out. He's a public servant shaping national transportation policy. He's a teacher. He's a Sultan. And he's still, by most measures, early in his career.

For young Muslim Filipinos looking for proof that they belong in engineering, in government, in the classroom, and in spaces of cultural leadership, Dr. Radiaganding's story makes that case without needing to say a word. He just lives it.

# References


- Profile provided by **Nasria Radiaganding** (https://www.facebook.com/profile.php?id=61577339382658)


# See Also

- Muslim Filipinos
- Maranao people
- Bangsamoro
- Philippine Railways Institute
- Department of Transportation (Philippines)
- Polytechnic University of the Philippines


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